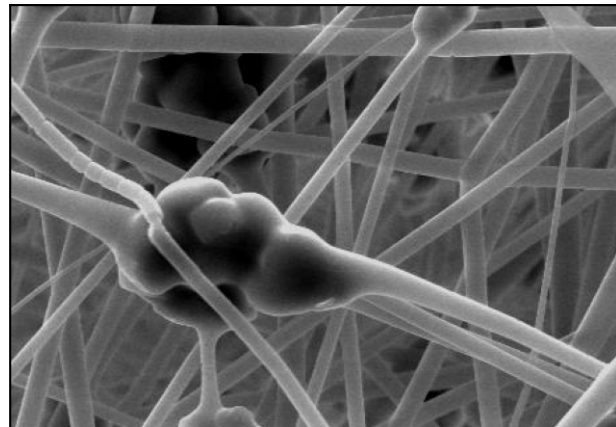


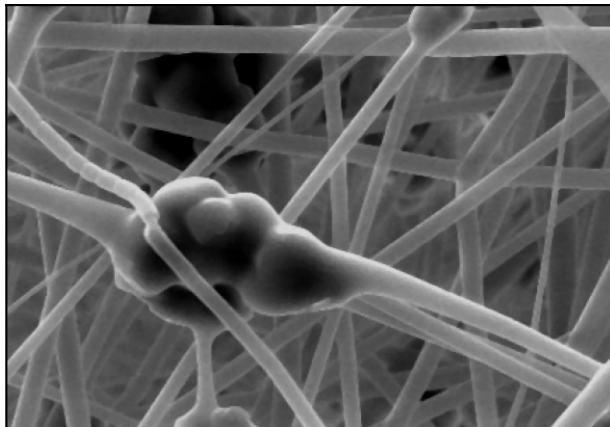
CLAHE gives the widest grey-level separation and the worst usable contrast: it raises the fibre texture as much as the beads

No preprocessing



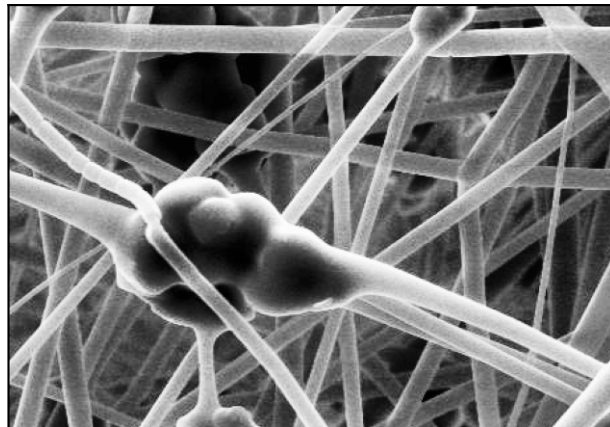
separation 23.6 grey levels
background s.d. 35.2 $\Delta/\sigma = 0.67$

Median filter, 3×3



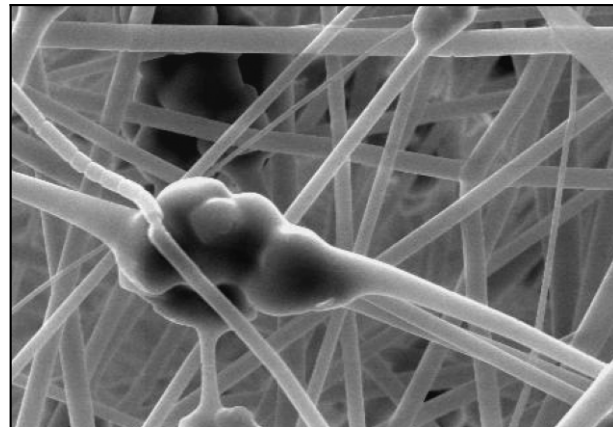
separation 23.6 grey levels
background s.d. 34.0 $\Delta/\sigma = 0.69$

CLAHE



separation 20.1 grey levels
background s.d. 60.9 $\Delta/\sigma = 0.33$

Background subtraction



separation 25.6 grey levels
background s.d. 36.7 $\Delta/\sigma = 0.70$